

The rufous hummingbird migrates from Mexico to its breeding grounds in Canada and Alaska.

Rufous hummingbird

So that it can feed on nectar during its journey, the rufous hummingbird times its migration to coincide with the blooming of flowers along its flight path.

Golden-cheeked warbler

This endangered warbler breeds in just a few patches of juniper-oak forest in Texas. It winters in the pine-oak woodlands that stretch from southern Mexico to Nicaragua, but these habitats are threatened by deforestation.

Red knot

Each spring, red knots travel from the tip of South America to their breeding grounds in the Canadian Arctic. They spend over half of the year on this 18,600-mile (30,000-km) round trip.

In the Atlantic, Arctic terns take different routes north and south, since they follow the prevailing winds.

Aquatic warbler

This rare songbird flies from eastern Europe to winter in Senegal.

Barn swallows breed in North America and winter from Mexico to South America.

Arctic tern

In August, this tern leaves its summer breeding grounds in the Arctic to fly to the other end of the world for the start of the Antarctic summer. Because it experiences two summers, it sees more daylight than any other animal.

Some Arctic terns fly up to 49,700 miles (80,000 km) per year.

Bird migration

Many birds breed in one location during summer and then fly off to spend winter somewhere warmer. The following year, they return to raise the next generation. These annual flights, or migrations, may cover thousands of miles and require incredible stamina.